ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 18: **The Book That Saved the Earth (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** they take simple nonsense verses as deep warnings	Literal reading.
2	**(d)** mistakes drive the plot	Errors.
3	**(c)** If the Martians had understood the book, they would have attacked.	Third conditional.
4	**(b)** it is a story told from a later time	Retrospective.
5	**(c)** failing to recognise books	Ignorance.
6	**(c)** A Comedy of Martian Errors	Reflects humour.
7	**(a)** misunderstanding or fear	Comic irony.
8	**(d)** they show the long-term peace	Resolution.
9	**(b)** dialogue meant for performance	Dramatic form.
10	**(d)** Think-Tank's pompous speeches	Pomp mocked.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The Historian speaks from a later age (1) and gives the comic story a historical air, adding irony (1).	1+1
12	It shows that war plans may rest on foolish assumptions (1) and that peace may come by accident rather than by wisdom (1).	1+1
13	Characters and reactions are comically extreme (1) which highlights the folly of the Martian mission (1).	1+1
14	They plan to conquer a world whose basic things they do not understand (1) so their power rests on ignorance (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Humour comes from the comic misreadings and exaggerated pomp. Satire uses this to criticise war-making and blind confidence. Together they entertain and teach.	1+1+1
16	The comic retreat avoids war. The Historian adds that friendship later grew. The ending shows hope for peace.	1+1+1
17	(a) Where did the Martians go? (b) Who was the commander?	1+1+1
	OR: The Martians have powerful ships but lack understanding. Ignorance makes their power useless. True power needs knowledge.	1+1+1
18	The Historian as narrator, dialogue between characters, and comic situations. Dramatic irony makes the audience wiser than the Martians. These devices suit performance.	1+1+1
	OR: If the Martians had read the book properly, they would not have retreated. Third conditional.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Define satire (1). Pompous leader (1). Misreading of books (1). Folly of planning war (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Martians as outsiders (1). Their mistakes mirror ours (1). Satire on war (1). Satire on pride (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Martians do not know books (1). They read rhymes literally (1). They infer Earth's power (1). They retreat (1). Result: Earth is saved (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Introduction (1). Lesson from the play (1). Benefits of reading (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling it a serious play; it is a **humorous science-fiction play** by Claire Boiko, set in the future with Martians and Earthlings.
- Mixing the characters: **Think-Tank** (Martian chief), **Noodle**, Captain Omega, Lieutenant Iota and Sergeant Oop.
- Saying the book was a weapon; it was a book of **nursery rhymes (Mother Goose)** that the Martians misread as military secrets.
- Missing the irony: a simple book of *nursery rhymes* saved the planet because the Martians misunderstood it.
- Forgetting the setting: Probe One lands in the **Centerville Public Library** on Earth and the crew studies books.

- Writing the play summary in dialogue form; use *simple present tense* and third person.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 18: **The Book That Saved the Earth (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** wisdom should guide action	Wisdom.
2	**(a)** to comment on human behaviour from an outside view	Satire.
3	**(a)** understanding context before judging	Context.
4	**(d)** decided from a hasty reading	Hasty.
5	**(c)** led to peace	Good outcome.
6	**(b)** Think-Tank's strange interpretation of the rhymes	Reading error.
7	**(b)** The book was misread by the Martians.	Passive.
8	**(b)** the audience knows the rhymes are harmless while the Martians do not	Irony.
9	**(c)** peace can come through unexpected means	Hope.
10	**(a)** how meaning depends on understanding	Interpretation.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It is mostly dialogue with simple settings (1) and its humour works well on stage (1).	1+1
12	It makes the situation fantastic (1) and lets the writer comment on present habits through distance (1).	1+1
13	They read them literally and ignore the context (1) and build imaginary pictures of Earth's power (1).	1+1
14	He assists Think-Tank (1) and his reports and doubts add humour and show that no leader acts alone (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The meaning of the rhymes depends on how they are read. The Martians read them as facts. The play shows that wrong interpretation leads to wrong decisions.	1+1+1
16	The Historian's distance lets him treat the invasion with irony. It also shows that humankind survived. The time frame gives the play a humorous reflective tone.	1+1+1
17	The Martians prepare to attack and Think-Tank studies the book gravely. His reading grows more serious. The reader wonders what he will decide.	1+1+1
	OR: He is proud, confident and fond of speeches. He pretends to understand all but misreads everything. His leadership is comic and dangerous.	1+1+1
18	It warns against decisions based on rumour and half knowledge. It encourages dialogue and peace. It reminds us that culture can be a strength.	1+1+1
	OR: Solemnity about silly content creates humour. The contrast between tone and subject is funny. It also satirises official language.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduction (1). The book in the play (1). Other examples (1). Importance of reading (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Meaning of the title (1). The book is a children's book (1). Martians misread (1). Irony of salvation (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Think-Tank: pompous, authoritative (1). Noodle: assistant, practical (1). Their dialogue (1). The effect on humour (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Pompous words (1). Repetition (1). Comic names (1). Literal reading (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 18: **The Book That Saved the Earth (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** Noodle said that the book was dangerous.	Backshift.
2	**(d)** The Martians had planned to invade.	had + V3.
3	**(a)** relative clause	Relative.
4	**(d)** withdraw	Withdraw.
5	**(b)** Think-Tank is the silliest leader.	Judgement.
6	**(d)** self-importance	Pomp.
7	**(a)** Why does Think-Tank read the rhymes seriously?	Inference.
8	**(a)** could	Past possibility.
9	**(b)** not serious	Light.
10	**(a)** check facts before acting	Verification.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It is funny and imaginative (1) and uses familiar nursery rhymes in a new way (1).	1+1
12	A leader may decide from fear and error (1) so wise leaders need knowledge and advice (1).	1+1
13	It carries the stories of a people (1) and the Martians fear Earth because of its culture, not weapons (1).	1+1
14	The danger is removed (1) and the future is peaceful, with a gentle closing joke (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The Martians know nothing of Earth culture and imagine it wrongly. They fear what they do not understand. The play suggests learning before judging.	1+1+1
16	(a) The book was read by the Martians. (b) The retreat was ordered by Think-Tank.	1+1+1
17	Think-Tank gives orders and Noodle obeys and advises. Their talk shows pomp and a little doubt. The relationship is comic.	1+1+1
	OR: A library is a centre of knowledge but the Martians cannot use it. Their confusion about books is comic. The setting contrasts knowledge and ignorance.	1+1+1
18	The Martians retreated because they feared Earth.	1+1+1
	OR: The humour softens the lesson. The ending is happy and kind. It teaches without preaching.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	He opens the play (1). He gives context (1). He adds irony (1). He closes the story (1). Effect on audience (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Introduction (1). The Martian plan (1). The library (1). The retreat (1). The aftermath (1).	2+2+1
20	Format (1). Characters (1). Misunderstanding (1). Humour (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: The Martians prejudge Earth (1). They fear what they do not know (1). Wrong ideas lead to wrong acts (1). Knowledge removes prejudice (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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MASTERMIND